

DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

Revising EPS higher post 2Q, we see ability deliver core DPS step-up even in 2027

Buy

DBSM.SI 12m Price Target: **S\$57.20** Price: **S\$49.75** Upside: **15.0%**

DBS posted 2Q25 net profit of S\$2,824mn, +3%yoy/-3%qoq, slightly above GSe (see [First Take: 2Q25 slightly above GSe on lower CoC & better NIMs; 2025 guidance unchanged](#)). DBS reiterates that the previous guidance remains unchanged, and continues to expect stable PBT from 2024 (which was left out in the presentation slides), supported by slightly above NII bolstered by robust deposit growth, robust fee income especially in wealth and stable asset quality. We revise up our 2025/26/27E net income estimates by +3.7%/+2.1%/+2.4% to S\$10,742/S\$11,028/ S\$11,618mn as we bake in higher NIM realized in 2Q25 with our NII now flattish yoy for 2025, and higher non-NII. That said our PBT is still down 2% yoy for 2025 with on our more conservative non-NII growth at 5% on weaker other non-NII declining 3% yoy offsetting 12% fee income growth. Another key focus at the analyst briefing was DBS's capability to sustain the S\$0.24 annual step-up in core DPS going forward amid the lower rate environment. DBS sees itself capable to sustain S\$0.24 DPS step up for 2025 and 2026 based on current profitability outlook, and the bank remains committed to returning S\$8bn of excess capital as previously announced. We see scope for core dividend step up to continue in 2027 as we forecast ROEs of 16.8%% in 2027E. Overall this implies 65%/69%/70% core dividend payout within our calculated neutral payout range of 60%-70%.

Overall, we see this as a decent set of results, demonstrating steady performance across operation lines despite lower rates and a highly volatile market environment in second quarter, which showcases the bank's strong franchise and effective management. Additionally, the reaffirmation of the core DPS step-up is a positive in this environment which affirms a rising dividend yield trajectory. We maintain our Buy rating on DBS. Our 12-m target price is revised

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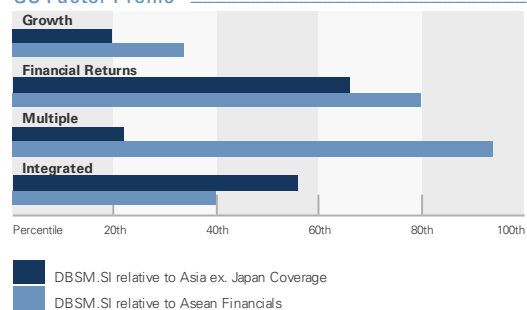
Key Data

Market cap: S\$140.4bn / \$109.2bn
3m ADTV: S\$205.0mn / \$159.4mn
Singapore
Asean Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	11,409.0	10,741.9	11,028.4	11,617.8
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	11,409.0	10,361.6	10,799.4	11,346.3
EPS (S\$) New	4.01	3.81	3.94	4.18
EPS (S\$) Old	4.01	3.67	3.86	4.08
EPS growth (%)	10.9	(5.1)	3.5	6.1
P/E (X)	8.9	13.1	12.6	11.9
P/B (X)	1.5	2.1	2.0	2.0
Price/PPOP (X)	10.5	10.5	10.2	9.7
Dividend yield (%)	6.2	6.2	6.6	7.1
	6/25	9/25E	12/25E	3/26E
EPS (S\$)	0.99	0.95	0.82	1.05

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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Buy

DBS Group (DBSM.SI)

Rating since Sep 1, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
P/E (X)	8.9	13.1	12.6	11.9
Price/PPOP (X)	10.5	10.5	10.2	9.7
P/B (X)	1.5	2.1	2.0	2.0
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	6.2	6.2	6.6	7.1
Div. payout ratio (%)	55.4	80.4	83.8	84.7

Growth & Margins (%)

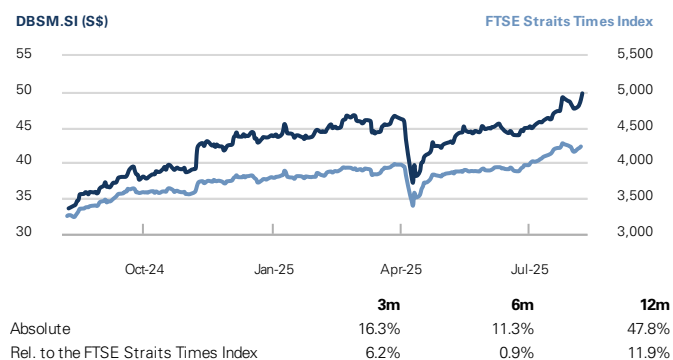
	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
BVPS growth	11.3	2.7	2.1	2.0
Total revenue growth	10.5	2.0	3.0	5.2
Op. profit growth	10.5	(0.0)	2.3	5.8
Net inc growth	10.9	(5.8)	2.7	5.3
EPS growth	10.9	(5.1)	3.5	6.1
DPS growth	27.2	37.8	7.8	7.3

Asset Quality

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.1	0.2	0.2	0.2
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.1	1.1	1.2	1.2
NPL ratio (%)	1.1	1.1	1.2	1.2
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.4	1.4	1.5	1.5
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	50.1	50.8	52.7	54.7
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	127.4	129.0	126.2	124.0

Capital Item

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	17.7	16.9	16.5	16.0

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 7 Aug 2025 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net interest income	14,424.0	14,470.4	14,298.4	14,521.6
Net fees	4,168.0	4,675.2	5,376.5	6,191.3
Treasury income	3,381.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	324.0	3,596.0	3,750.0	3,937.5
Total revenue	22,297.0	22,741.6	23,424.9	24,650.4
Compensation & benefits exp.	(5,594.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(3,301.0)	(9,339.8)	(9,713.3)	(10,150.4)
Pre-provision op. profit	13,402.0	13,401.9	13,711.6	14,500.0
Provision for loans	(623.0)	(901.7)	(958.7)	(1,064.4)
Total provision expense	(622.0)	(911.7)	(958.7)	(1,064.4)
Income/(loss) from associates	250.0	287.5	296.1	310.9
Pre-tax profit	13,007.0	12,765.7	13,048.9	13,746.5
Provision for taxes	(1,599.0)	(2,025.8)	(2,022.6)	(2,130.7)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	11,409.0	10,741.9	11,028.4	11,617.8
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	11,409.0	10,741.9	11,028.4	11,617.8
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	4.01	3.81	3.94	4.18
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	4.01	3.81	3.94	4.18
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	2,846.4	2,823.0	2,801.1	2,780.9
Avg. yield on loans (%)	4.2	3.9	3.8	3.7
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	4.3	3.5	3.1	3.0
Cost of fund (%)	2.5	1.8	1.4	1.4
Net interest margin (%)	2.0	1.9	1.8	1.7

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Domestic mortgages	85,746.0	87,602.1	91,066.4	95,263.8
Domestic non-mortgages	41,579.0	42,341.2	44,015.6	46,044.4
Domestic commercial lending	273,334.0	281,352.9	292,479.1	305,960.0
Total overseas lending, gross	240,608.0	449,832.7	467,621.5	489,175.0
Gross loans to customers	436,684.0	449,832.7	467,621.5	489,175.0
Total NPLs, gross	4,780.0	5,013.9	5,446.0	5,941.6
Total loan loss reserve	6,090.0	6,466.8	6,875.0	7,365.4
Net customer loans & advances	430,594.0	443,366.0	460,746.5	481,809.6
Other interest earning assets	105,053.0	109,494.0	109,494.0	109,494.0
Interest earning assets	756,247.0	794,244.1	821,561.2	849,347.9
Other non-int. earning assets	70,972.0	64,834.5	65,260.5	65,703.9
Total assets	827,219.0	859,078.6	886,821.7	915,051.7
Risk weighted assets	352,002.0	364,222.9	379,759.1	395,781.1
CASA deposits	291,066.0	314,777.6	336,181.2	357,975.3
Non-CASA deposits	270,664.0	276,295.3	281,727.9	287,269.1
Customer deposits	561,730.0	591,072.9	617,909.1	645,244.5
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	63,313.0	51,734.0	51,734.0	51,734.0
Total liabilities	758,386.0	790,393.9	817,230.1	844,565.5
Total shareholders' equity	68,833.0	68,684.7	69,591.5	70,486.3
Total liabilities & equity	827,219.0	859,078.6	886,821.7	915,051.7
BVPS (\$\$)	23.33	23.96	24.47	24.97
RWA/assets (%)	42.6	42.4	42.8	43.3

Profit Drivers

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net customer loan growth (%)	3.5	3.0	3.9	4.6
Net interest margin (%)	2.0	1.9	1.8	1.7
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	39.9	41.1	41.5	41.2
Tax rate (%)	12.3	15.9	15.5	15.5
CASA ratio (%)	51.8	53.3	54.4	55.5
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	76.7	75.0	74.6	74.7

Profitability

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.8	2.7	2.7	2.7
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.7	1.6	1.6	1.6
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.7	1.5	1.5	1.5
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.5	1.3	1.3	1.3
Leverage (X)	12.0	12.5	12.7	13.0
ROE (%)	18.1	16.0	16.2	16.8
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	17.4	15.6	16.0	16.6

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

up to S\$57.2 (based on 2-stage DDM) from S\$54.5 previously. Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanaged top management transition.

More details from the briefing:

- **Targets to achieve 2025 NII slightly above 2024 level** with the expectation of 2 Fed cuts in 2025. Regarding NIMs, Jun exit NIM was 1.98% and falling slightly to 1.95% by Jul. DBS notes the pass-through between Fed rate and SORA/HIBOR has diminished in the current environment and to provide greater clarity on NIM sensitivity, DBS detailed its exposure by currency - for S\$ book, per 1bps decline leads to S\$9mn decline in NII, based on S\$90bn floating rate assets, while for non-S\$ book, per 1bps decline leads to S\$4mn increase in NII, attributed to S\$40bn net floating rate liability. Despite the sharp drop in SORA and HIBOR, DBS expects NII to be cushioned by the robust deposit growth, at +5% YTD and +7% yoy on constant currency basis, with strong momentum continuing into July. This deposit growth is viewed as structural and widespread across markets, driven by increasing market share. Furthermore, when Fed rates lower and S\$ strengthen, DBS expects more funding flowing to DBS and will further support deposit growth and NII. We expect flat NII yoy, with NIM of 2.04% baking in 5 additional Fed rate cuts and loan growth of 3%.
- **Commercial book non-NII in 2025 to deliver mid-to high-single digit growth.** Wealth management remained robust, +25% yoy, supported by 12% yoy AUM growth and net new money rising a solid S\$9bn in 2Q25. DBS is confident to sustain a S\$20bn net new money on annual basis, and sees good momentum in increasing investment activities. We forecast total fee income to come in at +12%, driving +5% non-NII growth in 2025E.
- **Asset quality remains manageable.** DBS maintains 2025 SP guidance unchanged at 17-20bps. The bank emphasizes its highly conservative approach to risk management, which includes ongoing stress testing and a cautious loan appetite, particularly for SME and unsecured consumer loans. The bank sees its S\$2.6bn management overlay providing sufficient cushion against macro uncertainties. On HK CRE exposure, DBS has lowered exposure to S\$17bn, mostly in conglomerate names with a 60% LTV and healthy cash-flow, and has allocated additional provisions for this exposure. Overall we view DBS asset quality as sound and we forecast 2025E credit cost of 21bps.
- **Core DPS S\$0.24 step-up achievable in 2025/26.** Capital remains robust with fully-loaded CET1 standing at 15.1% by 2Q25. DBS remains committed to returning S\$8bn of excess capital as previously announced and notes the core dividend step-up will be subject to annual review at year end. Based on current profitability outlook, DBS sees itself capable to sustain S\$0.24 DPS step up in 2025 and 2026. We expect DBS to sustain S\$0.24 per share step-up through to 2027E, implying 65%/69%/70% core dividend payout, at the higher end of the bank's capital neutral payout range of 60%-70%.
- **Early mover in digital asset ecosystem.** DBS has commenced its digital assets

offering as early as 2021, with comprehensive ecosystem offering from issuance & listing, to trading & custody, and payment & settlement. DBS is optimistic about the profitability outlook in digital assets, with the bank's digital asset business already generating new earnings streams. The bank aims to become a key infrastructure provider in this space, leveraging its early start to strengthen its position. DBS also emphasizes it will maintain operations within regulatory approval ranges.

Exhibit 1: DBS 2025 Results Summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	2Q25E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	3,594	3,597	3,728	3,681	3,648	2	(1)	3,681	(1)
Fee & Commission	1,048	1,109	968	1,275	1,167	11	(8)	1,234	(5)
Other Non-Interest Income	840	1,047	809	949	917	9	(3)	896	2
Non-Interest Income	1,888	2,156	1,777	2,224	2,084	10	(6)	2,130	(2)
Operating Income	5,482	5,753	5,505	5,905	5,732	5	(3)	5,650	1
Operating Expenses	(2,172)	(2,249)	(2,395)	(2,214)	(2,270)	5	3	(2,279)	(0)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	3,310	3,504	3,110	3,691	3,462	5	(6)	3,370	3
Loan Loss Provisions	(148)	(130)	(209)	(325)	(133)	(10)	(59)	(227)	(41)
Pre-tax Profit	3,213	3,440	2,960	3,437	3,388	5	(1)	3,218	5
Net Profit	2,733	3,027	2,523	2,897	2,824	3	(3)	2,727	4
Core Net Profit	2,752	3,027	2,623	2,897	2,824	3	(3)	2,727	4
Balance sheet (\$\$mn)									
Assets	790,111	789,609	827,219	840,823	841,896	7	0	848,626	(1)
Gross Loans	430,912	424,000	436,684	442,000	439,100	1.9	(0.7)	446,330	(2)
Non-Performing Loans	4,754	4,240	4,780	4,862	4,452	(6)	(8)	4,997	(11)
Customer Deposits	551,088	544,961	561,730	575,663	573,965	4	(0)	583,189	(2)
CAMEL Ratios (%)									
Core Tier 1	14.8	15.2	15.1	15.2	15.1			14.8	
NPL Ratio	1.10	1.00	1.09	1.10	1.01			1.12	
Loan Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	14	12	19	30	12			20	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.14	2.11	2.15	2.12	2.05			2.00	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	39.6	39.1	43.5	37.5	39.6			40.3	
Loan-to-Deposits	78.2	77.8	77.7	76.8	76.5			76.5	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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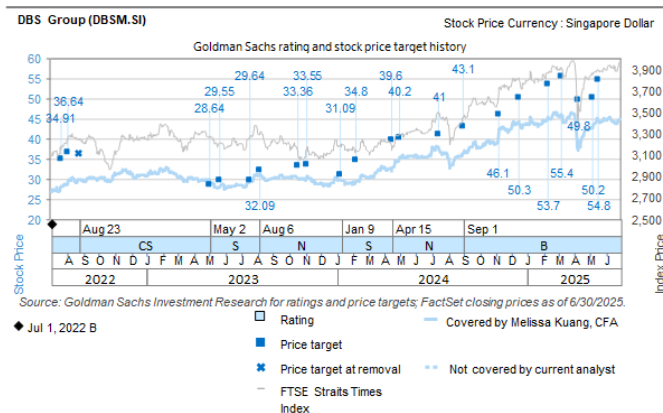
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